A TECHNICAL REPORT ON

STUDENTS' INDUSTRIAL WORK EXPERIENCE SCHEME (SIWES)

UNDERTAKEN AT

IBW CONSULTS NIGERIA LIMITED.

No. 3, Osuntokun Avenue, Old Bodija, Ibadan, Oyo State.

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ARC/22/0590

SUBMITTED TO:

THE DEPARTMENT OF ARCHITECTURE,

SCHOOL OF ENVIRONMENTAL TECHNOLOGY,

FEDERAL UNIVERSITY OF TECHNOLOGY, AKURE.

CERTIFICATION

This is to certify that the accompanying report is a complete account of the Student Industrial Work Experience Scheme (**SIWES**) undertaken by **MAKANJUOLA DOMINION MOYOSORE** with matric number **ARC/22/0590**, at **IBW Consults Nigeria Limited**, for the period **27th April, 2026 – 9th October 2026**, in accordance with the regulations guiding the Department of Architecture, Federal University of Technology, Akure, in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the award of a Bachelor of Technology in Architecture.

……. ……

Name of Student Signature & Date

…….. ……

Industrial-based Supervisor Signature & Date

DEDICATION

I dedicate this report, and the season of growth it represents, first and foremost to **God Almighty**, the source of every ounce of strength, clarity, and grace that carried me through this training. In the moments when I felt out of my depth, on site or in the studio, it was His guidance that steadied me, and for that I am endlessly thankful.

To **my parents**, whose sacrifices laid the very foundation of everything I have been able to achieve, thank you for believing in me long before I believed in myself, and for the quiet, steady support that never once wavered, even when this journey demanded more of you than words can fully capture. Every drawing I produced and every site I visited during this training carries a piece of what you have poured into me.

To **my sibling**, thank you for the laughter, the encouragement, and the simple reassurance of knowing I never had to walk this road alone. Your presence in my life has been a gift I do not take for granted.

To everyone at **IBW Consults Nigeria Limited**, from the Principal Partner down to every staff member and other intern students who took the time to explain, correct, and guide me, thank you for opening your firm to me and treating my learning as something worth investing in. This training could easily have been a formality; instead, it became a genuinely transformative chapter of my journey, and I dedicate this report to that experience and to everyone who shaped it.

Finally, to every student who will one day pick up a report like this one and begin their own SIWES journey, may you find, as I did, that the effort is always worth it.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I am deeply grateful to God Almighty for granting me the strength, wisdom, and good health needed to complete this Student Industrial Work Experience Scheme (**SIWES**) successfully. My heartfelt appreciation goes to my parents and family for their constant encouragement, prayers, and support throughout this journey.

I extend my sincere gratitude to the management and staff of IBW Consults Nigeria Limited for providing me with a rich and instructive learning environment. Special thanks go to the Principal Partner, **Arc. Benjamin Ibidun**, and the firm's Associate Partners, **Arc. Ajani Joel** and **Arc. Adeala Adekunle**, for their leadership and for creating a firm culture where interns are genuinely mentored rather than simply assigned tasks. I am also thankful to the firm's technical team, **Engr. Odunayo Aderemi, Engr. Olarewaju Stephen**, and the wider architectural and quantity surveying staff for their patience and willingness to explain the reasoning behind their work whenever I asked.

My particular thanks go to my industrial-based supervisor, **Arc. Benjamin Ibidun**, whose mentorship, patience, and hands-on guidance shaped much of what I now understand about professional architectural practice. Finally, I acknowledge the Department of Architecture, Federal University of Technology, Akure, for structuring this program and giving me the opportunity to participate in it.

ABSTRACT

This report documents the knowledge and practical experience acquired during my Student Industrial Work Experience Scheme (SIWES), undertaken over a period of **six[6] months/Twenty-four[24]** at IBW Consults Nigeria Limited, an indigenous architectural consulting and construction firm based in Old Bodija, Ibadan, Oyo State.

The report is organized into five chapters. Chapter One introduces the SIWES program and its objectives. Chapter Two presents the profile, history, services, and structure of IBW Consults Nigeria Limited. Chapter Three details my studio-based experience, covering the design software used at the firm, **AutoCAD**, **Revit**, and **Lumion**, and the specific projects I contributed to, including a three-bedroom bungalow, a Baptist Church design, a CAC Church working-drawing package, and design observations from an ongoing duplex project at Akobo.

Chapter Four covers my construction site experience, spanning setting-out, foundation excavation, pile foundation work, blockwork, laterite filling and compaction, reinforcement, beams and columns, building renovation, and attendance at site and project meetings across sites in Akobo, Alaba Rago Market (Lagos), Carlton Gate, Apata, Old Bodija Estate, and the University College Hospital (UCH), Ibadan. Chapter Five summarizes the skills acquired, challenges encountered, and recommendations for strengthening the program, before concluding with a reflection on how the training bridged the gap between classroom theory and professional architectural practice.

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CHAPTER 1

1.0 INTRODUCTION

The effective education of students in tertiary institutions across diverse disciplines depends significantly on the integration of practical, hands-on experience alongside academic instruction. To facilitate this, the Students Industrial Work Experience Scheme (SIWES) serves as a crucial component, offering students a valuable opportunity to experience real-world work environments and apply their academic knowledge in practical settings. This experience enhances their productivity and readiness for the workforce upon graduation. Under this program, students are placed in relevant organizations within their respective fields for a defined training period, during which they are exposed to the day-to-day realities of professional practice and realities that a lecture hall, however well taught, cannot fully replicate.

This report provides a detailed account of my training experience at **IBW Consults Nigeria Limited**, with a focus on the methodologies, procedures, and technical aspects involved in architectural design and building construction. It spans both the studio and site dimensions of the firm's work, and highlights the challenges encountered during training, along with recommendations for potential improvements to the scheme.

1.1 BACKGROUND OF THE INDUSTRIAL TRAINING FUND (ITF)

The Industrial Training Fund (**ITF**) was established as a government agency with the primary aim of developing and training the Nigerian workforce, in line with post-independence initiatives for economic growth. The ITF's mandate was to foster a shift away from reliance on foreign expertise toward building a skilled, indigenous workforce capable of driving Nigeria's key economic sectors forward. Since its inception, the ITF has remained committed to this mission, consistently working toward Nigeria's economic self-sufficiency through the development of local manpower.

1.1.1 FUNCTIONS OF THE INDUSTRIAL TRAINING FUND

The establishment decree of the ITF empowered a governing council to set policies and oversee the following responsibilities:

- Provide and support training facilities for employees.
- Approve training courses and facilities offered by employers.

- Regularly assess areas of industry requiring specialized manpower development.
- Recommend necessary training standards and ensure they are upheld.
- Assist individuals in locating training opportunities and securing industry employment.
- Conduct or support research into training requirements within various industry sectors.

1.2 OVERVIEW OF SIWES

The Students Industrial Work Experience Scheme (**SIWES**) was founded in 1973 by the ITF to bridge the gap between academic theory and real-world professional application. It was designed to help students acquire practical skills that complement the academic knowledge gained in higher institutions, ensuring they are well prepared to meet the demands of their chosen professions upon graduation. SIWES primarily targets students in fields such as Engineering, Environmental Technology, Sciences, Agriculture, Technical, and Business Studies, promoting close collaboration between academic institutions and industry so that students can develop competencies specific to their field of study.

1.3 AIMS AND OBJECTIVES OF SIWES

SIWES was established with the following goals:

1. **Bridging Theory and Practice**: enabling students to apply classroom learning to practical work, linking academic knowledge with industry realities.
2. **Skill Development**: offering students, particularly in engineering and related fields, the chance to gain practical skills and experience relevant to their studies.
3. **Employer Engagement**: encouraging employer involvement in education, preparing students for successful careers in industry.
4. **Career Readiness**: helping students transition smoothly from academic to professional environments by familiarizing them with actual work settings.
5. **Exposure to Advanced Tools**: providing students access to equipment and methods not readily available at school, enhancing their technical knowledge.
6. **Increased Interest and Performance**: cultivating students' enthusiasm and understanding of their disciplines through practical exposure, thereby improving academic performance.

1.4 GROWTH OF THE SCHEME

Since its inception, SIWES has steadily expanded in scope and reach. What began as a modest program involving a small number of institutions has grown over the decades to encompass a much wider network of universities, polytechnics, and colleges of education across Nigeria. As the country's industrial and construction

sectors continue to develop, SIWES is expected to keep growing in relevance, supporting the evolving needs of the Nigerian workforce.

1.5 SCOPE OF THE SCHEME

SIWES requires a period of practical training for students in Engineering and related fields, typically undertaken during the third or fourth year of study. For architecture students at institutions such as the Federal University of Technology, Akure, this program is compulsory and forms a credit-bearing component of the curriculum, focused specifically on field experience. My own training at IBW Consults Nigeria Limited spanned **a period of six[6] months, from 27th of April, 2026 till 9th of October, 2026**, during which I was exposed to architectural design, working drawings, computer-aided design, visualization, and construction/site-related activities.

1.6 ROLES OF STAKEHOLDERS IN THE SIWES PROGRAM

Role of the ITF: The ITF's responsibilities include supervising students on placement, organizing orientation programs, formulating SIWES policies, processing institutional placement lists, and coordinating the distribution of allowances to students and supervising staff.

Role of Institutions: Academic institutions play a key role by establishing SIWES coordination units, ensuring adequate funding and oversight, preparing specifications for accredited courses, and helping students secure suitable placements within their field of study.

Role of Coordinating Units: Coordinating units appoint full-time industrial coordinators, establish minimum guidelines for placement and supervision, and oversee SIWES activities to ensure successful execution of the program from placement through to reporting.

CHAPTER 2

2.0 COMPANY PROFILE: **IBW CONSULTS NIGERIA LIMITED**

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2.1 HISTORY/BACKGROUND OF THE COMPANY

IBW Consults Nigeria Limited is an indigenous architectural consulting and construction firm established over five years ago. The firm is wholly committed to delivering world-class, value-added services, particularly in the area of turn-key projects, that is, projects taken from initial concept through to full delivery under one coordinated service. Since its establishment over six[6] years ago, IBW Consults has designed, supervised and constructed a wide range of structures spanning residential facilities, specialized and institutional buildings, and commercial developments, alongside a broader portfolio of consultancy services.

Over the years, the firm has built and maintained a network of skilled professionals and workforce partners, carefully selected to ensure that competent and efficient resources are applied to every client objective, at competitive and negotiable rates. This collaborative approach allows IBW Consults to take on projects of varying scale and complexity without compromising on quality or turnaround time.

2.2 COMPANY PHILOSOPHY AND EXPERTISE

IBW Consults positions itself around three core professional identities, each carrying a distinct set of responsibilities and commitments to the client:

- **As Architects**, the firm is committed to developing outstanding, cost-effective design concepts tailored to each client's preferences and budget, without compromising on design quality or the firm's professional standards.
- **As Planners**, IBW Consults places emphasis on climate-friendly and sustainable construction practices, the adoption of current technology in project delivery, and high-quality project management, implementing best practices on every project to ensure it is completed on time and within budget.
- **As Project Managers**, the firm is positioned to proffer practical solutions on behalf of its clients, staying closely involved with a project's progress to ensure it is carried through to successful completion.

This three-pronged approach, **architect**, **planner**, and **project manager**, is part of what distinguishes IBW Consults' service offering, allowing the firm to manage a project's full lifecycle rather than handing off responsibility once a design is approved.

2.3 SERVICES AND AREAS OF SPECIALIZATION

The services rendered by IBW Consults Nigeria Limited include:

- **Architectural Design**: concept development through to detailed design documentation.
- **Landscape Design**: planning and design of outdoor and site environments.
- **Urban Planning**: layout and planning services at a neighbourhood or estate scale.
- **Estate Management**: oversight of developed properties on behalf of clients.
- **Cost Analysis and Project Documentation**: budgeting, cost estimation, and preparation of project documents.
- **Interior Decoration**: design and finishing of interior spaces.
- **Refurbishment of Old Properties**: renovation and upgrading of existing structures.
- **Design and Build Services**: combined design and construction delivery under a single engagement.

2.4 STRUCTURE OF THE COMPANY

IBW Consults is led by its Principal Partner, **Arc. Benjamin Ibidun** (MNIA, HND Architecture, PGD, M.Tech Architecture), supported by **Arc. Ajani Joel**, Associate Partner (MNIA, B.Tech Architecture, M.Tech Architecture), and **Arc. Adeala Adekunle**, Associate Partner II (B.Sc Architecture, M.Arch). The firm's technical team includes **Engr. Odunayo Aderemi** (B.Tech, M.Sc Civil Engineering) and **Engr. Olarewaju Stephen** (M.Eng Mechanical Engineering), alongside architectural staff and a quantity surveying officer. Administrative operations are managed by the Company Secretary/Accountant, **Mrs. Oluwatobiloba Adufuwa**.

This multidisciplinary structure allows IBW Consults to deliver projects efficiently from conception through to completion, drawing on in-house expertise across architecture, civil and mechanical engineering, quantity surveying, and project management, rather than having to outsource every specialist function to external consultants.

2.5 PROFESSIONAL RECOGNITION AND REGULATORY COMPLIANCE


Federal Republic of Nigeria
Industrial Training Fund
CERTIFICATE OF COMPLIANCE

IBW Consults Nigeria Limited is duly registered with the Corporate Affairs Commission (**CAC**) and holds a valid Income Tax Clearance Certificate, Industrial Training Fund (**ITF**) Compliance Certificate, and Nigeria Social Insurance Trust Fund (**NSITF**) Clearance Certificate. The firm is further registered on the National Database of Federal Contractors, Consultants and Service Providers (IRR). These certifications collectively demonstrate the firm's regulatory standing and its eligibility to bid for and execute both private and public-sector projects.

2.6 NOTABLE PROJECTS

Over the years, IBW Consults Nigeria Limited has built a diverse project portfolio, including:

- ICT Hub for Federal Government College, Ogbomoso
- Administrative Building, Immanuel College of Theology, Samanda, Ibadan
- Event Hall, Gbagi, Akobo, Ibadan
- Office and office complex facilities, Osuntokun Avenue, Old Bodija, Ibadan
- Warehouse facility, Osuntokun Avenue, Old Bodija, Ibadan
- Fragrance Hotel Apartment, Idi-Ape GRA, Ibadan
- Church auditoriums in Akobo, Ibadan and Ipetu-Osun, Osun State
- Residential developments in Ibadan, Osun State, and Kaduna

At the time of my training, the firm was also engaged in the proposed development at Alaba Rago Market, Lagos State, alongside proposed residential apartments at Akobo and Apata, Ibadan, Oyo State, giving me the opportunity to observe projects at multiple different stages of the design and construction pipeline simultaneously.


Commercial
Administrative Building
Immanuel College of Theology,
Samanda, Ibadan.
Constructed 2019-2025


Commercial
Office complex
No. 3 Osuntokun Avenue, Bodija
Akinleye Fajemiyo House, Ibadan.


Commercial
Event hall
Gbagi Akobo, Ibadan. Constructed 2009
Mayor's Place

CHAPTER 3

3.0 STUDIO EXPERIENCE AND DESIGN/DOCUMENTATION SOFTWARE

My office-based responsibilities at IBW Consults Nigeria Limited involved architectural design, drafting, and documentation work using industry-standard software. This exposure strengthened both my technical software proficiency and my understanding of how a design moves from initial concept sketches through to construction-ready documentation. Working in the studio also gave me a much clearer sense of how design decisions are shaped by practical constraints such as client budget, site conditions, structural feasibility, and regulatory requirements, rather than by aesthetics alone.

3.1 AUTOCAD

AutoCAD was used extensively for architectural drafting. During my training, I worked on polyline and roof-drawing exercises, which helped build my precision and speed in 2D technical drawing and reinforced my understanding of drafting conventions used for construction documentation and dimensioning.

3.2 REVIT

Revit, a Building Information Modelling (BIM) software, was central to much of my studio work. I used Revit in the development of a three-bedroom bungalow design and in preparing working drawings for a CAC Church project, gaining experience in model-based design, scheduling, and documentation. Working with Revit's parametric modelling environment also taught me how changes to a single element automatically propagate across an entire drawing set, which underscored the importance of building models correctly and consistently from the outset.

3.3 LUMION

Lumion was used for architectural visualization, allowing design ideas to be presented to clients and stakeholders in a realistic, immersive format that aided decision-making and communication. I came to appreciate how a well-produced visualization can bridge the gap between a technical drawing, which a client may struggle to read, and a real understanding of what a finished space will actually look and feel like.

3.4 THEORETICAL KNOWLEDGE GAINED DURING THE INTERNSHIP

3.4.1 ROLES OF PROFESSIONALS IN THE CONSTRUCTION INDUSTRY

The construction industry is inherently collaborative, requiring the coordinated input of several professionals, each with a distinct area of responsibility:

Architects are licensed professionals trained in both the artistic and technical aspects of building design. They conceptualize and develop plans for structures, ensuring designs are functional, safe, cost-effective, and responsive to user needs, while adhering to relevant codes, zoning laws, and safety regulations. Their responsibilities often span the full project lifecycle, from client consultation and feasibility studies through to detailed design and construction oversight.

Quantity Surveyors are experts in estimating and managing construction costs. They assess the labor, materials, and equipment required for a project, working to ensure it is completed within budget while maintaining the specified quality standards.

Engineers including structural, civil, and mechanical engineers, ensure the technical soundness of a design. They translate architectural intent into structurally sound, code-compliant systems, providing the technical backbone that makes a design buildable and safe.

Building Contractors oversee the physical execution of construction, managing labor, coordinating tasks, and ensuring that work is carried out according to the approved project plan and within regulatory requirements.

The Clerk of Works (or Site Inspector) is responsible for verifying that construction is carried out according to specifications and quality standards, conducting regular site inspections to confirm that materials, workmanship, and safety practices meet the required benchmarks.

The Client is the individual, organization, or entity commissioning the project, ranging from private individuals to institutional bodies or property developers, whose brief and budget shape the entire direction of the work.

3.4.2 PROJECT MANAGEMENT

Construction project management involves coordinating resources including time, money, materials, equipment, and personnel, to complete a project on schedule and within budget. It requires close collaboration among the professionals listed above to manage every phase of the building lifecycle, from initial planning through to completion, while balancing client needs, stakeholder expectations, and site or environmental constraints. Observing this coordination in practice at IBW Consults,

particularly during site meetings, gave me a much more concrete understanding of project management than I had gained from classroom instruction alone.

3.5 STUDIO PROJECTS

A. THREE-BEDROOM BUNGALOW

***Project Type**:* Residential project.
***Project Role**:* Design development, floor plans, elevations, sections, construction details, and design revisions

Project Description: I was involved in the design development of a three-bedroom bungalow from an early stage, contributing to the layout of floor plans and the development of elevations and sections. As the design progressed, I worked on producing construction details to support the working drawing package, and assisted in incorporating revisions as feedback was received which is an experience that taught me how a design is rarely finalized in a single pass, but refined iteratively as constraints and preferences are clarified.

***Deliverables**:* Floor plans, elevations, sections, construction details, and revised drawing sets reflecting design feedback.

B. BAPTIST CHURCH

***Project Type**:* Religious/Institutional project
***Project Role**:* Face-lifting, Façade development, architectural research, floor-plan development

***Project Description**:* My involvement on this project centred on the building's façade, developing design options that reflected the character appropriate to a religious building while remaining buildable within the client's constraints. This required a degree of architectural research into comparable religious buildings and design precedents, which I carried out alongside my floor-plan development work.

***Deliverables**:* Façade design options and supporting floor-plan development work.

C. CAC CHURCH

***Project Type**:* Religious/Institutional
***Project Role**:* Preparation of working drawings using Revit

***Project Description**:* I developed working drawings for the CAC Church project using Revit, translating the approved design into detailed, construction-ready documentation. This involved ensuring that the model was accurately dimensioned and annotated so that it could be reliably used on site by the construction team.

***Deliverables**:* A working drawing set produced in Revit for construction use.

D. AKOBO DUPLEX

***Project Type**:* Residential
***Project Role**:* Site observation of ongoing construction

***Project Description**:* I made a site visit to observe the ongoing construction of a duplex at Akobo, paying particular attention to how blockwork and wall construction were being carried out in relation to the approved building design. This visit directly connected my studio-based documentation work to what was actually happening on the ground, helping me appreciate how carefully a working drawing needs to be prepared in order to be correctly interpreted and executed by the construction team.

CHAPTER 4

4.0 CONSTRUCTION SITE EXPERIENCE

Beyond studio work, a significant part of my training involved direct exposure to active construction sites, where I observed how architectural drawings and specifications are translated into physical structures. This site experience gave me a far more concrete understanding of construction sequencing, coordination, and the practical challenges that arise between design intent and site execution.

4.1 OVERVIEW OF SITE WORKS

In construction, site works encompass all activities related to preparing and shaping a project's physical site, from initial surveying and excavation through to utilities installation, concrete works, and eventual landscaping. Site works play a crucial role in the smooth progress of a project, laying the groundwork (often literally) for everything that follows, from the building's shell through to its interior fit-out.

4.2 SETTING-OUT

I observed the setting-out process for a semi-detached three-bedroom building at Akobo, using pegs, profiles, lines, nails, hammers, and a builder's square to accurately transfer the building's layout from drawing to ground. This stage is a critical checkpoint, any inaccuracy at setting-out carries through the entire construction process and observing it firsthand gave me a much clearer appreciation of why precision at this early stage matters so much.

4.3 FOUNDATION EXCAVATION

I observed foundation trench excavation works, paying attention to correct dimensions, alignment, and levels as specified in the structural drawings. I also gained insight into how excavation depth and width are determined by soil conditions and the specified foundation type, rather than being fixed values applied uniformly across every site.

4.4 PILE FOUNDATION

Among the more instructive site visits during my training was my trip to the proposed development at Alaba Rago Market, Lagos, one of IBW Consults' ongoing projects at the time. Unlike the residential sites I had grown accustomed to around Ibadan, most of which relied on strip or raft foundations, this site introduced me to pile foundation construction, a system I had until then only encountered in textbooks.

On site, I observed the installation of piles driven deep into the ground to transfer the building's load down to a stronger, more stable soil layer, bypassing the weaker

upper soil strata that would otherwise be unable to support the structure safely. I watched as the piling rig positioned and drove each pile, and paid close attention to how the process was sequenced and supervised to ensure each pile reached the required depth and alignment before work moved to the next. Alongside the piling works, I observed the associated pipe installations being carried out concurrently, and gained a clearer sense of how utility routing is planned around, rather than as an afterthought to, the foundation system.

Speaking with the site engineers helped me understand the reasoning behind the choice of a pile foundation for this particular site, a decision driven largely by the soil conditions and the anticipated loading of the proposed structure, both of which made shallow foundation types unsuitable. This was a valuable lesson in itself: that foundation type is never a default choice, but a decision shaped by geotechnical investigation, structural load requirements, and site-specific constraints.

This exposure gave me a much richer appreciation for how varied foundation engineering can be from one project to the next, and how a system I had only read about in class could be understood so differently once I saw it executed on the ground. It remains one of the site experiences I found most eye-opening during my entire training period.

4.5 BLOCKWORK

Blockwork activities were observed at the Akobo site, including the setting-out of the damp-proof course (DPC) level and the construction of walls for the duplex project. I paid particular attention to how mortar joints, block alignment, and vertical plumb were maintained and checked throughout the process.

4.6 LATERITE FILLING AND COMPACTION

I observed laterite filling and compaction works at the Akobo site as part of ground preparation ahead of further construction. This process, bringing the site to the correct level and compacting the fill to provide a stable base, is easy to overlook in a drawing set but plays a significant role in the long-term stability of the finished structure.

4.7 REINFORCEMENT

I observed foundation and starter-column reinforcement work at a site at Carlton Gate, gaining insight into how reinforcement bars are positioned, spaced, and tied in accordance with structural specifications, and how starter bars are left projecting to connect the foundation to the columns above.

4.8 BEAMS AND COLUMNS

At a site in Apata, I observed an inverted beam and horse bench, along with foundation blockwork and other associated structural works. This deepened my understanding of how beams and columns function together within a building's structural frame, and how formwork is used to shape concrete elements before they are cast and cured.

4.9 BUILDING RENOVATION

I inspected a renovation site at Arigidi Estate, Old Bodija Estate, where cracks and structural deformation had been identified. Repair works involved damaged walls, beams, and columns. This experience gave me insight into how existing structural defects are diagnosed, how their likely causes are assessed, and how repair works are planned and carried out without compromising the safety of the rest of the structure.

4.10 SITE MEETINGS

I attended a site meeting for the construction of a Public Health Care Multipurpose Building at the University College Hospital (UCH), Ibadan, and was subsequently involved in preparing the meeting minutes. This experience highlighted just how much of a construction project's success depends on clear communication and coordination among the various stakeholders including architects, engineers, contractors, and clients, and how meeting minutes serve as an important record of decisions and action points going forward.

4.11 BUILDING MEASUREMENT AND BILLING

I participated in building measurement and billing activities at the UCH site, gaining practical exposure to how completed works are quantified and valued for payment purposes. This gave me a working understanding of how the drawings and specifications produced in the studio ultimately connect to the financial and contractual side of a construction project.

4.12 CONSTRUCTION SITE SAFETY

Ensuring the safety of a construction site is a critical part of any construction-related activity, aimed at protecting workers from potential hazards including injury, illness, or worse. Safety practices are integral to every work environment, helping to prevent and mitigate accidents while supporting the wellbeing of everyone on site.
Throughout my site visits, I paid close attention to the following practices, which were consistently emphasized:

- Use of Personal Protective Equipment (**PPE**) at all times.
- Commencing work only after proper site induction.

- Keeping the work area tidy to reduce potential hazards.
- Taking personal responsibility for one's own safety and that of others nearby.
- Following posted safety signs and established work procedures.
- Reporting defects, hazards, or near-misses promptly.
- Never tampering with safety equipment or protective barriers.
- Maintaining clear and effective communication with the site team.
- Asking questions and seeking clarification whenever in doubt.

CHAPTER 5

5.0 SUMMARY OF TRAINING EXPERIENCE

My SIWES training at IBW Consults Nigeria Limited provided a well-rounded exposure to both the studio and site dimensions of architectural practice. In the studio, I strengthened my proficiency in AutoCAD, Revit, and Lumion while contributing to real design and documentation work on residential and religious building projects, from early-stage concept and façade development through to construction-ready working drawings. On site, I gained first-hand exposure to construction sequencing, from setting-out and foundation work through to blockwork, reinforcement, structural framing, and renovation, as well as the coordination, documentation, and communication that keeps a project on track from one stage to the next.

Perhaps most valuably, the training helped me see how these two sides of the profession, studio and site, are not separate disciplines but two ends of the same process. A drawing produced in the studio only has value once it can be correctly read, interpreted, and executed on site, and the site experience I gained gave me a much sharper sense of how to produce documentation that actually works in practice.

5.1 SKILLS ACQUIRED

- Architectural design and preparation of working drawings
- AutoCAD drafting, including polyline and roof-drawing techniques
- Revit modelling, scheduling, and construction documentation
- Lumion visualization and client-facing presentation
- Interpretation of architectural and structural drawings
- Setting-out and foundation-related site activities
- Understanding of blockwork, reinforcement, beams, and columns
- Diagnosis and repair of structural defects during building renovation
- Participation in, and documentation of, professional site meetings
- Building measurement and billing procedures
- Awareness and practice of construction site safety

5.2 PROBLEMS/CHALLENGES FACED DURING TRAINING

- **Adapting theoretical knowledge to practical situations:** Some concepts learned in the classroom required genuine adjustment once applied to real site conditions, sequencing, and constraints that a textbook example rarely captures.
- **Becoming familiar with construction processes and professional documentation:** Early in the training, understanding site terminology,

established procedures, and professional documentation practices took some time to adjust to, particularly in my first few weeks.

These challenges, while initially uncomfortable, ultimately contributed meaningfully to my adaptability and professional growth over the course of the training period.

5.3 RECOMMENDATIONS

Drawing from my experience, I would offer the following recommendations to strengthen the SIWES program for future participants:

- Students should be given sufficient exposure to both office (**studio**) and site-based responsibilities during their placement, as each builds a distinct but complementary set of skills.
- Practical training should be more closely coordinated with classroom instruction, so that theoretical concepts are reinforced by, rather than disconnected from, what students encounter on placement.
- Students should be encouraged to build a working proficiency in industry-standard architectural software, particularly AutoCAD and Revit, ahead of their SIWES placement, so that placement time can be spent on more advanced, project-specific learning.
- Students should be given more opportunities to participate directly in professional meetings and site supervision activities, as these build communication and coordination skills that are difficult to teach in a purely classroom setting.
- Institutions should maintain closer supervision and communication with host firms throughout the placement period, to ensure students are receiving meaningful guidance and are being assigned tasks appropriate to their level of training.

5.4 CONCLUSION

The SIWES program at IBW Consults Nigeria Limited provided me with a genuinely transformative, hands-on introduction to professional architectural practice. Over the course of my training, I gained experience across architectural design, computer-aided design and visualization, and a wide range of construction site activities, from setting-out and foundation work through to blockwork, reinforcement, structural framing, renovation, and formal site meetings. This experience strengthened my technical and professional competencies considerably and gave me a much clearer, more grounded understanding of how design and construction come together in practice, beyond what classroom instruction alone could offer.

I leave this training period with greater confidence in my technical abilities, a stronger appreciation for the collaborative nature of the construction industry, and a solid foundation to build on as I continue toward professional practice. It is recommended

that the SIWES program continue to be supported, monitored, and refined, to ensure that future students derive the same, or greater value from their own placements.

5.5 REFERENCES

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